

car fan. The idea is to buy cars that combine performance with luxury. A sports car will always be a showpiece; [it] will hardly see the light of day," says Agarwal. Next on the cards for him are the Ferrari Purosangue and the Lamborghini Urus, but they both have very long wait periods. "I would also like to buy a Bentley. They have started modernising themselves," he says.

He loves to drive his cars on Sunday mornings when the roads in Mumbai are relatively empty. He says while he bought the Maybach thinking he would sit in the rear, once he drove the V12 engine-powered car, he was hooked. "The sheer power of it! I now find the V9 Maserati rather weak," he laughs.

Agarwal says his company is doing sales of approximately ₹50 crore a month, with 40 per cent of the sales coming from online. He currently has 16 Pernia's Pop-Up

"I set up my company in 2015 and waited seven years, travelling around in a rented Innova, till I had the means to buy the Maybach"

Studio stores and three Wendell Rodricks stores. Nearly 80 per cent of his online sales are from outside India. "That's because we have only one store in London. When we have opened more stores globally over the next few years, this percentage will go down." In June last year, Purple Style Labs raised \$10 million in Series B funding led by Akash Bhansali and Madhuri Dixit. Agarwal says the company hopes to close the 2022-23 financial year with gross sales of ₹750 crore. **BT**

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TURNING TABLES Pankaj Jathar is the designated DJ at most family gatherings

THE ACCIDENTAL DJ

Pankaj Jathar, VP & Country Head-India at Etsy, enjoys mixing music and entertaining guests with his DJ skills

BY NIDHI SINGAL

Pankaj Jathar, Vice President and Country Head-India of Etsy, an e-commerce company focussing on hand-made products by small sellers, has an ear for music. Little wonder, then, that his friends and family often designate him the in-house DJ for parties and get-togethers.

What started as just having fun became a serious passion around three years ago when he purchased a DJ set. "I was told that I have a good ear for the kind of music that would work with a particular audience, and I also enjoyed the process. Encouraged by this feedback, I tried to explore this a little more and bought a DJ set," says the 49-year-old.

Professional DJs use many types of equipment, including a controller, turntable and CDs or digital audio files on a computer, to name a few. "I use a Hercules Inpulse 300 DJ controller, a Behringer Xenyx 502 mixer and headphones for mixing and playing my music. I often also use my phone to mix music," says Jathar. In

addition, he has five different speakers, each fulfilling a very specific function.

While Jathar enjoys listening to and playing all genres of music, he predominantly plays retro—1970s and 1980s western pop, Bollywood and Indipop. "I enjoy listening to music and playing for people. It's great to see others enjoying the music I pick and having a good time, so you can say that I enjoy this aspect of being a DJ," he says.

Jathar likes to host gatherings at home so he can play his kind of music and also does occasional stints at his residential society. At a recent office offsite, he even played for his team. Jathar is self-taught, having learnt from online tutorials and experimenting with music.

The India head of Etsy has also recorded some of his work, and a few sets are available on Mixcloud, a British online music streaming service that allows for the listening and distributing of radio shows, DJ mixes and podcasts. **BT**

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